NHMEC Wellness Herbalist Diploma

Module 4: Seasonal Wellness Planning

Professional Registration Diploma

Estimated Completion Time: 25–30 Hours

Module Overview

Creation follows seasons, and so does the human body.

One of the distinguishing characteristics of a Wellness Herbalist is the ability to recognize how environmental changes influence wellness. Temperature, sunlight, humidity, activity levels, food availability, emotional patterns, and spiritual rhythms often shift throughout the year.

Rather than offering the same wellness recommendations year-round, the Wellness Herbalist develops seasonal wellness education plans that encourage individuals and families to work with the rhythms of creation.

This module explores seasonal wellness from both a biblical and holistic perspective while teaching students how to develop practical seasonal wellness education plans using herbs, nutrition, lifestyle modifications, and the Holistic P.E.N. Way™.

Learning Objectives

Upon completion of this module, students will be able to:

- Explain the relationship between seasonal changes and wellness.
- Identify common wellness priorities for each season.
- Integrate herbs, nutrition, and lifestyle recommendations into seasonal wellness plans.
- Develop individualized seasonal wellness education guides.
- Apply the Holistic P.E.N. Way™ framework throughout the changing seasons.
- Teach seasonal wellness within an educational scope of practice.

Required Reading

Primary Text

The Wellness Herbalist: A Guide to Family, Community, Kitchen, and Seasonal Wellness

Read:

- Chapter 2 – Studying the Seasons
- Chapter 6 – Seasonal Wellness Practices

Companion Manual

Review:

- Winter Wellness Overview
- Seasonal Wellness Charts
- Holistic P.E.N. Way™ Seasonal Framework
- Kitchen PENothecary™ Seasonal Preparation Sections

Recommended Enrichment

Students are encouraged to complete the following NHMEC Continuing Education Workshops:

- Winter Wellness Workshop – Level 1
- Winter Wellness Workshop – Level 2
- Winter Wellness Workshop – Level 3

These workshops expand upon the seasonal concepts presented in this module but are not required for diploma completion.

Understanding Seasonal Wellness

Throughout Scripture, God established seasons as part of His created order.

Ecclesiastes 3:1 reminds us:

> "To every thing there is a season, and a time to every purpose under the heaven."

The Wellness Herbalist recognizes that people often experience seasonal changes in:

- Energy
- Nutrition
- Physical activity
- Immune challenges
- Emotional wellness
- Sleep patterns
- Hydration
- Social activities

Understanding these rhythms allows the Wellness Herbalist to provide timely and practical wellness education.

Spring: Renewal

Wellness Focus

Spring is traditionally associated with renewal, growth, and preparation.

Educational Priorities

- Fresh foods
- Hydration
- Outdoor activity
- Gentle movement
- Seasonal meal planning
- Kitchen organization

Traditional Herbs Often Associated with Spring

- Dandelion
- Burdock
- Nettle
- Chickweed
- Cleavers

Lifestyle Focus

- Spring cleaning
- Garden planning
- Walking
- Time outdoors
- Fresh seasonal produce

Summer: Growth

Wellness Focus

Summer emphasizes activity, hydration, and protection.

Educational Priorities

- Hydration
- Electrolyte balance
- Fresh fruits and vegetables
- Sun awareness
- Outdoor wellness
- Community activities

Traditional Herbs

- Peppermint
- Lemon Balm
- Hibiscus
- Chamomile
- Basil

Lifestyle Focus

- Gardening
- Outdoor meals
- Family gatherings
- Community outreach
- Physical activity

Autumn: Preparation

Wellness Focus

Autumn is a season of preparation and strengthening.

Educational Priorities

- Nutrient-dense meals
- Pantry organization
- Immune-supportive nutrition
- Herbal preparation
- Harvest preservation

Traditional Herbs

- Elderberry
- Astragalus
- Rose Hips
- Garlic
- Ginger

Lifestyle Focus

- Meal preparation
- Herbal inventory
- Seasonal planning
- Gratitude
- Family traditions

Winter: Restoration

Wellness Focus

Winter encourages rest, reflection, nourishment, and restoration.

Educational Priorities

- Rest
- Sleep hygiene
- Warm meals
- Herbal teas
- Emotional wellness
- Indoor movement

Traditional Herbs

- Ginger
- Cinnamon
- Garlic
- Licorice Root
- Thyme

Lifestyle Focus

- Devotional time
- Journaling
- Warm nourishing foods
- Family connection
- Reflection

Seasonal Nutrition

The Wellness Herbalist encourages individuals to enjoy foods that naturally align with the changing seasons.

Examples include:

Spring

- Leafy greens
- Sprouts
- Fresh herbs

Summer

- Berries
- Cucumbers
- Tomatoes
- Melons

Autumn

- Squash
- Sweet potatoes
- Apples
- Root vegetables

Winter

- Soups
- Stews
- Fermented vegetables
- Whole grains
- Warm herbal beverages

Applying the Holistic P.E.N. Way™

Seasonal planning should include all three pillars.

Perspective

How might this season influence:

- Spiritual disciplines?
- Gratitude?
- Community involvement?
- Personal reflection?

Essence

How might this season affect:

- Stress?
- Emotional health?
- Relationships?
- Daily routines?

Nutrition

How should:

- Meals
- Herbs
- Hydration
- Activity
- Rest

change throughout the year?

Individualized Seasonal Wellness

Not every person experiences the seasons in the same way.

Factors to consider include:

- Age
- Occupation
- Climate
- Activity level
- Family responsibilities
- Existing lifestyle habits

- Personal goals

Seasonal wellness education should always be individualized.

Case Study

Client Profile

John is a 58-year-old construction worker entering the winter season.

Observations

- Less physical activity due to weather
- Reduced water intake
- Increased reliance on processed convenience foods
- Reports poor sleep
- Limited fresh produce intake

Educational Wellness Priorities

Perspective

- Encourage daily devotional routine.
- Practice gratitude during seasonal changes.

Essence

- Develop consistent sleep habits.
- Encourage stress management strategies.

Nutrition

- Increase warm nutrient-dense meals.
- Introduce herbal teas.
- Encourage hydration.
- Add seasonal fruits and vegetables.

Reflection

Journal the following:

- Which season do you personally enjoy the most?
- Which season presents the greatest wellness challenges?
- How have your own wellness habits changed throughout the year?

- How can seasonal awareness improve wellness education?

Module Assignments

Assignment 1

Four-Season Wellness Calendar

Create a professional seasonal calendar that includes:

- Wellness priorities
- Nutrition goals
- Lifestyle recommendations
- Seasonal herbs
- Spiritual practices

Assignment 2

Seasonal Wellness Guide

Develop a 5–10 page educational booklet that includes:

- Spring
- Summer
- Autumn
- Winter

Each section should contain:

- Wellness goals
- Suggested foods
- Traditional herbs
- Lifestyle recommendations
- Biblical encouragement

Assignment 3

Seasonal Family Wellness Plan

Design a year-round wellness plan for a fictional family of four.

Include:

- Seasonal meal planning
- Herbal preparations
- Outdoor activities
- Community involvement
- Kitchen organization
- Wellness routines

Vocabulary

Define the following:

- Seasonal Wellness
- Adaptation
- Renewal
- Restoration
- Nourishment
- Hydration
- Resilience
- Stewardship
- Harvest
- Prevention

Discussion Questions

1. Why is seasonal wellness an important part of holistic herbal practice?
2. How can nutrition be adapted to each season?
3. What role does rest play during winter?
4. How can the Wellness Herbalist encourage families to embrace seasonal living?
5. How does the Holistic P.E.N. Way™ apply differently throughout the year?

Module Quiz

25 Multiple Choice Questions

Topics include:

- Seasonal wellness
- Seasonal nutrition
- Traditional seasonal herbs

- Holistic P.E.N. Way™ integration
- Lifestyle recommendations
- Family wellness planning
- Professional scope of practice

Passing Score: 80%

Students who do not achieve a passing score may review the module and retake the assessment.

Preparing for Module 5

In Module 5, students will transition from seasonal planning into advanced therapeutic kitchen herbalism, learning how to organize a professional kitchen apothecary and integrate food, herbs, and nutrition into individualized wellness education plans.